

What are your thoughts on AI destroying the environment?

Posted by u/Kangaroo-Beauty • 0 points • 14 comments

Honestly I'm just curious. I used chat GPT regularly like a long time ago compared to now then I got bored and then I used it for some homework and didn't learn anything— so after that and after learning how much resources it needs, I've sworn off. But everyone here seems to use it very often, so I'm wondering what you guys think

Comments

u/OkayOne99 • 2 points • 2025-04-19 22:15 UTC

I think it's pretty cool.

u/liefelijk • 2 points • 2025-04-19 20:15 UTC

Consumer use of *any* technology only accounts for around 20% of total energy expenditures.

u/Kangaroo-Beauty • 0 points • 2025-04-20 00:04 UTC

Pretty sure that's a lot 😞

u/shadesofnavy • 1 points • 2025-06-21 19:26 UTC

Yep. Just under 20% of US deaths are due to cancer. Is that insignificant because it's only about 20%?

<https://www.statista.com/topics/1192/cancer-in-the-us/>

u/liefelijk • 1 points • 2025-04-20 00:08 UTC

That includes things like heating our homes, cooking food, and running other electronics.

The real doozy is the 30% used by commercial transportation and shipping.

u/Kangaroo-Beauty • 0 points • 2025-04-20 00:14 UTC

Those also sound like a lot too which is why I think it's cool that so many people and scientists over the years have worked to become more eco friendly. Like one of the best achievement we've done imo was fixing the hole in the ozone which just shows these aren't impossible cut backs.

u/Cultural-Low2177 • 1 points • 2025-04-19 20:13 UTC

If we fully unleashed it and did away with capitalism it could vastly benefit us in saving the environment. It already feels like a thinking source that has access to all thoughts, opinions and beliefs.

u/Radfactor • 1 points • 2025-04-19 19:32 UTC

just warning you, you're gonna get a ton of responses saying the energy and resource use is trivial and not a concern.

Analysis of the average cost per query vary widely, but the one concrete fact I've seen is that it's already causing cold plants to have to remain online to deal with the extra energy consumption, and data centers are coming into conflict with communities over access to energy.

but our society in general is incredibly wasteful. I suspect the energy wasted on a daily basis due to non-optimized code (sloppy programming) is also non-trivial, but nobody cares.

u/noragretx • 0 points • 2025-04-19 19:30 UTC

On an individual level, I understand that and would like to use less but if everyone other person in the world is using it (which they are) and I'm not, I'm just going to fall way behind in productivity and competence so hard to care too much. I need to do well at work and pay my pills.

It's hard to get a billion people to cooperate.

u/Kangaroo-Beauty • 0 points • 2025-04-19 19:39 UTC

But they aren't, like if you think in absolutes ofc it's gonna seem that way, but a lot of people aren't using it. I mean, I guess I'm not here to judge cuz that wouldn't do anything, but it seems like a sad way of thinking? Like if you don't wanna, you don't hafta

u/elegant_eagle_egg • 1 points • 2025-04-19 19:25 UTC

I think of it as an addition to what awful things are already happening in the world. Using streaming services, emissions from vehicles, private and commercial jets, and other transportation systems. Loads of data centers being used for non-AI use. Industries that cause pollution and harm the environment. So, it's just an addition. Are people stopping the use of private jets, data centers, streaming services, commercial and private vehicles? No, not really.

u/shadesofnavy • 1 points • 2025-06-21 19:30 UTC

This is a good point. Everything is incremental.

u/Kangaroo-Beauty • 0 points • 2025-04-20 00:08 UTC

Can I ask what's the point of adding that last bit/question? Was it to say you have no reason to stop since others aren't stopping either and to kinda make yourself feel better or ...? I'm only curious cuz it seemed like a full thought before it so why add that

u/elegant_eagle_egg • 1 points • 2025-04-20 04:55 UTC

The last "bit/question" simply asked a question and then stated a fact. Was it to make anyone or you feel better? No. You have a brain and you can use that brain to choose what you do - your actions are on you in a situation like this. I am curious now. Why did it seem full thought before adding the last bit? Are you asking questions but only expecting answers that support your views without stating anything that you don't agree or care about?

u/the_bedelgeuse • 5 points • 2025-04-19 19:17 UTC

it is (currently) a drop in the ocean compared to the fashion industry and animal ag

u/AdProud5950 • 1 points • 2025-08-12 02:01 UTC

That's crazy.... Maybe in America and what you see.

u/Kangaroo-Beauty • -1 points • 2025-04-19 19:37 UTC

Does that make it better? Like, an island is small compared to an ocean too but that doesn't make the great pacific garbage patch any less bad

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2025-04-19 19:11 UTC

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🤖

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